

SEASON 01 EPISODE 10

Running Animals

1 EXT. OUTSKIRTS - NIGHT

1

Juniper pushes through weeds, tallgrass: Before making it to the bus stop.

The same bus stop Eve ran from.

2 EXT. BUS STOP - NIGHT

2

JUNIPER (V.O.)
So I ran.

Juniper sits down. After repeated calls, he turns on satellite mode.

He begins drafting a long text.

3 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT

3

Louis falls on the floor, covering his eye.

HAZEL
You're not my brother!

LOUIS
(crying)
And you're not my sister!

His parents restrain them both- Belinda on Hazel, Henry on Louis

HENRY
The hell has gotten into you guys?!

LOUIS
Hazel, she's been smoking.

Belinda WHIRLS around.

BELINDA
What?!

HAZEL
Louis, shut up!

LOUIS
She's been smoking pot at the park with the bears! She's been doing weed every fucking Tuesday!

HAZEL
Louis! Shut up or I'm gonna fucking murder you!

HENRY
You knew this and you kept it from us?!

LOUIS
'Cause I wanted my sister, but even
that's too much!

Louis wrestles away.

HAZEL
(points)
Why is it him? Him who always gets
coddled by you guys when he does
something wrong, when he gets home
late?
(stomps)
I don't have rich assholes for
friends!

LOUIS
He's not an asshole!

HAZEL
Then he's a kissass and it's your
ass he's kissing! Huh? Isn't that
right, gayboy?

LOUIS
Fuck you!

BELINDA
Stop it! Stop!
(top of lungs)
Stop!

4 EXT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT

4

It's quiet.

5 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - NIGHT

5

Louis goes into his room and shuts his door. Henry
clutches his chest and falls onto the seat.

HENRY
(panting)
Oh my god...

BELINDA
Henry! Babe, babe...

Belinda hugs Henry. Hazel turns around and SLAMS the door.
The two parents just close their eyes. Eyebags all over.
Too tired to talk. They just lay.

6 INT. LOUIS'S HOME - DAY 6

Louis opens his eyes. The softball at the corner of the room.

A text from Juniper. A long one.

He sits up, then glances at the car.

7 EXT. LOUIS'S HOME - DAY 7

Louis fumbles with the keys. He pulls out of the driveway.

BELINDA
Louis! Louis!

Louis runs.

8 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - DAY 8

Louis, on the phone with Juniper.

LOUIS
June, where the hell are you?

Louis turns onto the driveway. He SMOGS- but veers lanes.

His breathing fast, he ZOOMS.

A sign: "YOU'RE LEAVING TALENS"

9 EXT. EPORA STATION - DAY 9

Louis parks. Juniper gets out. He dashes toward Louis and they hug.

LOUIS
What the fuck happened?

JUNIPER
You tell me! Wh-why is that here?

Louis and Juniper glance at the car.

LOUIS
Come on.

10 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - DAY 10

Louis steers. HONK! He's going too slow.

He turns to a lot. They breathe again.

LOUIS
I'm gonna need to practice.

As Louis does loops:

LOUIS
So you're telling me you came out to
your mom and now she's gone nuts?

JUNIPER
Started praying to turn me correct.
Turn me right.
(pants)
It's always about politics. When is
it not about politics?!

Louis parks.

JUNIPER
Say. What do you say we just find
somewhere to camp out for a week?
Until graduation?

LOUIS
I don't even know if my parents'll
see me walk at that point.
(sighs)
Let's take a moment to think what
we're doing. We're running away,
June. This is huge, and I don't have
money, and I made this decision on a
whim-

JUNIPER
I'll cover. We just need time, okay?
That's all.

The two untense. Their shoulders droop.

JUNIPER
Five days. Five days is all we need.

Juniper takes Louis's hand.

Louis gets the stickshift in reverse and they drive.

11 INT. FERGIE'S HOUSE - DAY

11

Fergie paces around the garage.

FERGIE
So track won't take us. Fjord's way
too big. Epora?

QUISHA
Epora's small, admittedly.

FERGIE
Is there anywhere better?

DAX
Hey, guys, check this out.

Eve glances at the computer. She GASPS.

She runs right up to it- reads the poster.

EVE
This is perfect! What'll it cost to
apply?

DAX
\$25 upfront.

EVE
Can we do this?

FERGIE
We're not big enough as a brand.

EVE
I know, but-

12 INT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - DAY

12

ROSALINE, an otter, on the phone with Eve, also pacing.

ROSALINE
No, they will take anyone.
Especially if it's from one of the
most diverse areas in the land.

EVE (V.O.)
You're telling me diversity is an
asset?

ROSALINE
Well, if Adeline's campaigning in
the north, is it not an asset? You
guys work together, her whole
campaign is about working together,
why not?

EVE (V.O.)
But we're not qualified.

ROSALINE
Well, Eve, look on the poster.
Beginners welcome. You guys have a
chance, you guys even performed at a
rally!
(pauses)
What do you say?

PETUNIA, a beaver, pops around the corner.

PETUNIA
Guys! Louis and Juniper are on the
phone with me!

EVE (V.O.)

What?!

13 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - DAY

13

Speaker on. Louis and Juniper holding hands.

LOUIS

Yeah, we're east- merge calls.

Petunia merges with Eve. The five of them on the line.

14 INT. VARIOUS LOCATIONS - DAY

14

QUISHA

Quisha from ABC club here, what do it do?

EVE

So if we do apply to them, how long will it take to hear back?

FERGIE

8 hours!

EVE

That's a fast turnaround! Christ!

DAX

How about this? We apply, wait 8 hours, and if we don't get a response, we'll just host a show in Fergie's garage.

LOUIS

Hold on. Can you catch us up to date? The hell is happening.

EVE

Fergie wants to have us perform one last time, since the band is probably not staying together after high school.

JUNIPER

Like the Beaties?

QUISHA

And since last week, we've been applying, but we've had no luck.

PETUNIA

You should do it.

QUISHA

That's what we've been saying, but the boys are pushing back!

ROSALINE
Classic boy behavior.

DAX
The hell?

LOUIS
So you're saying Adeline herself is
hosting a concert in the north end
of Cicada, where Petunia and
Rosaline live?

FERGIE'S GARAGE: THE POSTER.

REVEAL: IT'S ADELINE.

She's hosting a concession tour, reprising her old songs-
and she's looking for OPENERS.

EVE
So Petunia and Rosaline, you can
visit Cicada...

LOUIS
Meanwhile, me and June can drive
there.

PETUNIA
If you're really running away from
home for a week, I mean...

Louis and Juniper glance at each other.

PETUNIA
Not to enable y'all, but there's
always Cicada.

Louis and Juniper nod.

15 INT. FERGIE'S HOUSE - DAY 15

FERGIE
Let's pack just in case.

The group throws supplies into Fergie's car.

16 INT. PETUNIA'S HOUSE - DAY 16

PETUNIA
Patty!

They pack in the driver's seat and take off to Cicada.

17 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - DAY 17

LOUIS
Okay.

They pull out of the driveway and head to the open road.

AS THE DAY PASSES:

18 **EXT. WILDERNESS - DAY**

18

Louis and Juniper SHOOT through a stretch of fields.

JUNIPER

You're getting pretty good at this.

LOUIS

Don't jinx me.

Louis and Juniper stare at the open road, in silence.

LOUIS

Hey, June, let's stop. We're ahead
of everyone anyway.

(shrugs)

Sides, I could use a break.

Pulled out to a turnout, cars WHIZZING by every now and
then:

They drink water bottles and stare into the open prairie.

Crickets.

And them.

LOUIS

You check your texts yet?

Juniper shakes his head.

JUNIPER

This is wrong, Louis. It really is.

LOUIS

I know.

(drink)

But...

JUNIPER

Louis, have you ever been on a
family trip?

Louis shakes his head.

JUNIPER

I went to a nearby park along
highway 96 once. With John and the
rest of my family.

LOUIS
 (chuckles)
 Now that's a fact about you I don't
 know.

The wind blows.

LOUIS
 So this is wrong. But on a scale of
 1-10, how nice does it feel?

JUNIPER
 Fucking awesome.

Louis smiles. He chugs the rest of his bottle.

JUNIPER
 I'm tired, man.

LOUIS
 I'm fucking tired, too.

JUNIPER
 Probably more tired than I am.

LOUIS
 Don't compare.

Juniper closes his eyes and LEANS.

LOUIS
 Let's not think about home, just for
 some time, okay?

Juniper nods.

LOUIS
 I know.

Louis puts an arm around Juniper.

LOUIS
 I know.

19 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - DAY

19

Louis and Juniper lean back and pull the window up. They
 stare into the outside world.

A car whizzes by. Louis grabs the seat cover-
 Then brings himself back.

20 INT. GAS STATION - DAY

20

LOUIS
 Pump 5?

The cashier, a deer, hands him his receipt, staring him in the eyes.

He points at the receipt.

Louis doesn't care. He stares back.

Snags the receipt so hard it makes the machine leap.

The deer's eyes widen. He stands up, alert.

21 INT. EVE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

21

ERNIE, Eve's sister, arrives at home. She gets a text from FERGIE.

"GO FOR IT."

She COUGHS, hackles, until blood falls in the toilet.

Then she closes the door. As she turns around:

Eve stands before her.

ERNIE
You're late.

Eve smiles. She hugs Ernie.

EVE
Ernie?

ERNIE
Yes?

EVE
Can I maybe disappear for- for- five days?

ERNIE
(nervous laugh)
What for?

EVE
I wanna perform up north. We got accepted.

ERNIE
(excited)
Accepted into what?

EVE
Adeline's concession tour. As an opener. It'll be me, Fergie, Dax, Quisha, you know them?

Ernie shakes her head, smiling, approving- but gulps.

ERNIE

Eve, you know I work late hours. And you have graduation, and we need to fit your gown and-

EVE

We can worry about that when I get back.

Ernie glances over her shoulder, at the toilet.

Then back at Eve.

ERNIE

Fergie?

EVE

Not just Fergie. Louis, Juniper, Petunia, Rosaline.

Eve lets go. She gives her sister puppy eyes.

EVE

You told me to make friends in high school. Well, I did. And I'm ready to get out there, into the world. I am.

(clears throat)

Would it hurt to spend a week away from home?

Ernie breathes cautiously. She can't hold it in.

She lets out a FURIOUS COUGH- then falls to the floor.

EVE

Ernie!

ERNIE

(coughing)

I'm okay.

Ernie stands up to her feet.

ERNIE

Eve, I think you should go. Go, but... just make sure you get here on time for graduation.

Eve hugs Ernie.

EVE

Thank you. I'll send you a video.

Ernie smiles, pulls Eve in.

22 EXT. EVE'S HOME - NIGHT 22

Eve waves goodbye to Ernie. She walks to Fergie's.

23 EXT. FERGIE'S HOUSE - NIGHT 23

She appears, backpack on.

EVE

Ready.

The four toss into their seatbelts. They set on the road.

24 INT. FERGIE'S CAR - NIGHT 24

DAX

Woo!

QUISHA

Road trip! Road trip! Road trip!

Fergie smiles, shifts, out of the driveway.

Before leaving, he glances at his father in the garageway.

FRANK brings out a smoke. Nods at Fergie.

Fergie nods back.

Eve glances at the interaction. She sinks into her seat comfortably.

25 EXT. PETUNIA'S CAR - NIGHT 25

Petunia and Rosaline sit in the back, her aunt in the front.

PETUNIA

I wonder what Ganke's up to.

ROSALINE

Or Dad.

PETUNIA

I bet he's still catching.

Rosaline smiles.

26 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT 26

Louis and Juniper have their hands on the gearshift together.

They pass by a tree. A little turbulence, but mostly stable.

Juniper tightens his grip.

A car PASSES Louis. Louis HONKS.

LOUIS
Should we book soon?

JUNIPER
Unless you wanna crash at Petunia's.

LOUIS
Is she even-

JUNIPER
Well, considering how slow you're
going, she might've already passed
us.

But he brings out his phone anyway. RING RING. RING RING.

JUNIPER
What's the status?

EVE (V.O.)
Hey June!

Juniper's eyes sparkle. He glances at Louis.

JUNIPER
Is that Eve? You guys got the
venue?!

27 INT. FERGIE'S CAR - NIGHT

27

An email on Fergie's phone.

JUNIPER (V.O.)
No fucking way.

DAX
Yes fucking way!

JUNIPER (V.O.)
But what-

FERGIE
They're not accommodating us,
though. We're sleeping with
Petunia's family.

28 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT

28

Juniper's eyes go wide.

JUNIPER
You said Petunia's family?

FERGIE
What else did I say, dumbass?

Juniper mutes the phone.

JUNIPER
Should we-

Louis nods his head. Juniper unmutes.

JUNIPER
Okay, got it! We'll let you know!

29 INT. FERGIE'S CAR - NIGHT

29

FERGIE
Good luck driving! Also Louis!

30 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT

30

LOUIS
Yeah?

FERGIE (V.O.)
Did you turn on your headlights?
It's the stick on the left!

Louis flips the switch. The headlights GO ON.

LOUIS
Got it!

FERGIE (V.O.)
Right. Good luck! Don't fuckin' die
out there!

LOUIS
We will!

Juniper turns off the phone.

31 INT. FERGIE'S CAR - NIGHT

31

The call ends.

EVE
You know, what if this whole Adeline
thing is too good to be true?

FERGIE
We're probably not meeting with her
agency. I bet it's just the
fairgrounds hosting for her, and
she'll be there on her own time.

EVE
You think we're actually gonna see
her?

QUISHA
Guys, we got lucky. That's that. You
heard them on the phone, they
sounded desperate as hell.

32 INT. FERGIE'S HOUSE - NIGHT

32

Fergie paces on speaker. Quisha listens.

PR MANAGER (O.S.)
Yeah, no- no one will step up. No
one. They're all Gurnick this,
Gurnick that-

FERGIE
Gurnick ended his campaign a year
ago. No one's even heard of him
since.

PR MANAGER (O.S.)
Exactly!

33 INT. FERGIE'S CAR - NIGHT

33

The group shrugs.

QUISHA
So y'all have to cut it with the
negative car talk.

DAX
Let's say it is a scam. We get
visibility. Fergie, if you wanna go
to Fjord and become a performer- or
anyone for that matter- then won't
it be worth it?

QUISHA
You guys are also forgetting, this
is our grad night. Or grad "week."
We're supposed to be having fun at
the end of the day.

EVE
Fun. Isn't that what they want?
Isn't that what we want, too?

Fergie blinks at the road.

EVE
Fergie, you said it yourself. The
world's fucked up right now. That's
the whole point of this trip.

Fergie nods.

EVE

So, if all they want is to celebrate
some avian who ran for president,
and we're down for that, then I'd
say we're in alignment.

Fergie smirks.

QUISHA

Then it's decided. Now if you'll
excuse me-

Quisha puts on her tunes.

QUISHA

I'm gonna knock out.

Quisha closes her eyes. She begins to snore softly.

FERGIE

You too Dax?

DAX

Yeah. Night.

FERGIE

Night.

Dax begins to snore.

Fergie chuckles quietly.

EVE

What?

FERGIE

(smiles)

"Some avian" who ran for president?
She's just some avian to now?

EVE

Oh, Christ, I don't mean that she
isn't my idol anymore.

FERGIE

I know, but...

Eve rolls her eyes. She smiles.

34 EXT. FERGIE'S CAR - NIGHT

34

The car shoots across the road.

35 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT

35

Juniper dials Petunia.

36 INT. PETUNIA'S CAR - NIGHT 36

Petunia's phone is off, charging.

Rosaline's is in her bag, in silent.

The girls are sleeping. The aunt is concentrating.

37 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT 37

JUNIPER

(sighs)

Fuck, why didn't we get this sorted sooner?

LOUIS

We could always sleep in the backseat, if you catch my drift.

JUNIPER

Oh, fuck you. I don't wanna sleep in the backseat.

Louis shrugs.

JUNIPER

Unless maybe we pick up a blanket or something?

LOUIS

Maybe some snacks?

Louis glances at Juniper.

JUNIPER

Inflatable mattress.

LOUIS

Okay, now you're getting greedy.

38 EXT. CONVENIENCE STORE - NIGHT 38

Louis purchases two plush blankets from a store.

Behind the counter is a mouse.

Louis nods. The mouse nods back. The receipt comes out.

39 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT 39

Louis tosses the blanket into the back.

LOUIS

I had an awkwardly normal interaction just now.

Juniper raises his eyebrow.

LOUIS
Sleepy, pretty boy?

JUNIPER
Don't call me pretty boy.

LOUIS
Let's find a place to sleep, pretty boy.

40 EXT. BRIDGE OVERPASS - NIGHT 40

Louis glances over the edge.

The area in the underpass is dark.

41 EXT. FOREST AREA - NIGHT 41

Nothing around. Louis does a bush pee.

It lasts uncomfortably long. It's like a fucking horror movie.

Louis dashes into the car again.

42 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT 42

LOUIS
Holy fuck.

JUNIPER
Huh?

LOUIS
Dude, why is it, like, a fucking horror movie out there?

JUNIPER
You're fine.

43 EXT. CORN FIELDS - NIGHT 43

Louis stops. He glances out into the corn fields- pulls away.

44 EXT. CEMETARY - NIGHT 44

Louis glances at a bunch of graves.

45 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT 45

Louis glances at his map. There's a wildlife reserve.

46 EXT. CLIFFSIDE - NIGHT 46

Louis pulls to a stop, huddled close to a cliff wall.

The terrain is flat.

LOUIS
Here's fine, maybe?

Juniper opens his eyes. They nod.

The two head to the back. Louis grabs the keys.

Before he closes the trunk, he sniffs the air. Then follows Juniper into the back.

47 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT

47

They recline, grab a pillow-

And lay in the back of the car.

It's dead quiet. The two boys lay.

Juniper opens his eyes. He smiles at Louis. Then closes them.

JUNIPER
Good job on the road. Only gave me
like five headaches.

Louis laughs. They take a moment staring at each other.

LOUIS
Night, you complaining bitchass.

JUNIPER
Night, you...

Juniper holds his gaze.

JUNIPER
Louis?

LOUIS
Mm?

The stars hang brightly above, sending the faintest of light their way.

As the two sit in the back, Juniper asks:

JUNIPER
Wanna be my boyfriend?

Louis smiles. He nods.

LOUIS
(sarcastic)
No. I don't wanna be your boyfriend.

JUNIPER
...Can you spoon me?

Louis smiles immediately, they get into spooning position.

LOUIS
Night, bitchass.

JUNIPER
Night, boyfriend.

FADE TO BLACK.

48 INT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT

48

The sound of wings flapping.

Louis's eyes open. Slowly, surely.

He glances at his boyfriend in front of him.

Then he sees a shadow.

To his right, he slowly draws his vision,

TO A VULTURE STARING HIM RIGHT IN THE EYES.

Outside of the trunk of the car.

Louis JOLTS up, to sit.

The vulture doesn't remove his gaze.

He holds it for a few seconds...

Then flaps away.

Louis's eyes stay wide. He taps Juniper.

Juniper opens his eyes.

LOUIS
June, don't move.

Louis is staring out the window. Juniper's eyes go wide.

JUNIPER
What happened.

Louis shakes his head. He rushes to the driver's seat, paranoid, glancing everywhere.

He sticks the keys right into the driver's keyhole. But just then, a pair of TALENS comes CRASHING DOWN ON THE HOOD.

It FLICKS the car, kicking the windows.

LOUIS
Go, go, go!

CREAK! CREAK! CREAK! It pounds on the windows-

Just as Louis sets off.

But he's going too fast.

JUNIPER
Louis! Slow, slow, slow!

He's too late. Louis turns over the cliff. The car
TUMBLES.

IT TUMBLES, THEN ROLLS, THEN CRASHES-

Then comes to a stop.

The bird lands on the cliffside. He glances down at the
two boys:

Then flies off, into the distance, grabbing what LOUIS, if
he had just stopped 30 meters earlier would have seen-

A wrapped body.

49 EXT. LOUIS'S CAR - NIGHT

49

Louis's car sits, in the middle of a ditch, steaming.

It's night and no one will find them.

And just like that, panicking-

The vulture flies into the sky.

At the base of the car, a hand CLICKS to the front door.

50 INT. POLICE STATION - NIGHT

50

Belinda walks to the police station. She goes up to the
man in charge.

BELINDA
I'd like to file a report for a
missing kid, last seen northbound to
Cicada. He doesn't have a license,
he took the car and left-

POLICE
Ma'am, calm down. Give me his name,
ID, age, anything you can provide
for him.

51 **EXT. POLICE STATION - NIGHT**

51

Belinda walks out of the police station, cold and tired-
And she notices a dog- Jane- getting out of her car.

BELINDA

H-hey!

Jane stops. She turns around.

JANE

Do I know you?

Then her expression softens. Her eyes light up.

JANE

(confused)

Hey.

BELINDA

H-has your son gone missing?

Jane's eyes widen.

BELINDA

What's your number?

And as the two women speak...

CUT TO BLACK.